

Colfax Township
5594 N 192nd Avenue Walkerville, MI 49459
March 11, 2026 Meeting Minutes

General meeting called to order by Supervisor, David Leonard at 7:00 PM

Pledge recited:

Roll Call: Present: Stephanie Haight, Shelby Branch, David Leonard, Joni Gerard

Absent: N/A (one open trustee seat)

~Agenda updated to include Item K under new business. SH motioned to approve amended agenda, 2nd by SB. Voice vote: All Ayes. Motion carried 4-0.

~SH moved to accept minutes. 2nd by SB. Voice vote: All ayes. Motion carried. 4-0

~DL moved to accept treasurer's report, 2nd by JG. Voice vote: All ayes. Motion carried.

~DL moved to approve the payment of bills/payroll, 2nd by SH. Roll Call vote: SH, Aye; SB, Aye; DL, Aye; JG, Aye. Motion carried 4-0.

NEW BUSINESS

- A. DL recapped budget meeting. Noted items: increase in wage for election workers and Board of Review members. Also, the category of Attorney Fees has been added.
- B. DL motion to appoint Dean Walker to fill remainder of Stuart Overway's term. 2nd by JG. Voice Vote: All ayes. Motion passes 4-0. Mr. Walker sworn in by DL. The board welcomes Dean Walker to the position of Trustee. He is a member of the Walker family which was one of the pioneer families in the area. His ancestors have previously served in various capacities and he welcomes the opportunity to continue the tradition of public service.
- C. DL had a meeting with Arbore Farms to inform them of the bill grant regarding roads. He asked Arbore Farms to write a letter in support; they agreed to comply with the request. Arbore is addressing EGLE issues: They are currently looking into multiple ways to address the odors emanated from the site. The cemetery property was also addressed with no actual results determined.
- D. Board of Review update: One petition was addressed on Tuesday. The Board will meet again on Thursday 3/12 from 3-9 PM
- E. Data Center hand out was addressed. As we are not a zoned township, the ability for a data center to be put in is not in our control. Montague township is having an informational meeting Thursday, 3/12 at 7:00 PM. As DL has BOR, JG will attend.
- F. Michigan Energy Future is holding a presentation for township officials in Hart on 3/19/2026 to address Consumer's High Voltage Installation. DL and JG scheduled to attend.
- G. DL has been chosen by Oceana County Township Association to be a member of the county-wide Tax Allocation Board.
- H. SAM number renewal is needed. (SAM is a unique entity number which is needed to seek federal government funding). DL will look into renewing w/o paying a 3rd party. Rob Barefoot has offered to help in this endeavor.
- I. Boat launch water level is low. However, the boat launch belongs to the Road Commission, not the township. Additionally, the Road Commission authority ends at the waters edge; therefore, EGLE would need to become involved to obtain permits to dredge and improved launch. DL spoke with Senator Bumstead's office, who suggested possible grants. DNR states that it is difficult to obtain a grant for dredging. SH stated that the School Section Lake Association had been interested in helping with this project at one point. She will speak to the SSLA president.
- J. During the budget meeting, it was approved to have the beach professionally cleaned to begin the 2026 beach season. A new sign is needed, as the current one is not weathering well. John Urick states that he may be interested in creating a replacement. SB also states that the maker of the

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current sign has reached out to her about creating a replacement. It was mentioned and discussed that a durable plastic may be a better option, more lasting option than wood.

- K. Due to the West Shore Community College millage election on May 5, it was motioned by DL and 2nd by JG that the May Board Meeting be rescheduled to WEDNESDAY, MAY 6. Voice vote. All Ayes. Motion carries 4-0, meeting is rescheduled.

OLD BUSINESS

- A. Uganski will again be used for Trash Day (May 9 8 AM to 12 Noon)
B. JG provided an update of the Cemetery Veteran's headstone project. Oceana Veteran's Affairs office has contacted their national office, and JG meets with Jodi Slinkard at the Oceana office on April 9 to 'sign off' on paperwork to progress in the process of obtaining markers for our Civil War Veterans.

Citizen Comments

- ~ Mr. P. Erickson spoke of the Battery storage unit going into Section 1 of Leavitt Township which is related to Solar farms on Polk Road. This could also be a potential issue for the township (as we are unzoned) and the fire department is a volunteer unit with limited resources.
~Board presented 2 notebooks to Mr. Erickson for the Historical Society which contain information on those interned at the Colfax Township Cemetery.

Motion by SB to adjourn meeting, 2nd by DL. Voice vote: All Ayes. Meeting adjourned at 8:04 PM